

Chicago Tribune



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TUESDAY, APRIL 22, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

POPE FRANCIS 1936-2025

'GRATITUDE'



Pope Francis waves from the Popemobile on his way to attend the Via Crucis on Copacabana Beach in Rio de Janeiro during World Youth Day celebrations on July 26, 2013. Francis has died at age 88. **BUDA MENDES/GETTY**

Cardinal Cupich joins Chicago area in deep mourning

By Jonathan Bullington, Carolyn Stein and Ikram Mohamed
Chicago Tribune

In June 2015, seven months into his tenure as archbishop of Chicago, Blase Cupich was invited to Vatican City for a one-on-one conversation with Pope Francis.

The meeting, Cupich's first with the pontiff, was held at the pope's residence, Domus Santa Marta.

Immediately, Francis put the nervous Cupich at ease.

"He started the conversation by saying he wanted to meet the person he appointed to Chicago," Cupich recalled in an interview with the Tribune on Monday. "And I said I wanted to meet the person who appointed me to Chicago."

As their talk wound to a close, Francis stood to show Cupich to the elevator.

"I said, 'I know where it is,'" Cupich recalled. And Francis, flash-

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Rev. Esequiel Sanchez, Rector of the Shrine, attends a service at the Chapel of Saint Joseph at the Shrine of Our Lady of Guadalupe in Des Plaines after Pope Francis' passing on Monday. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

More coverage in Nation & World

World leaders pay homage: Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni of Italy led tributes to Pope Francis from political leaders around the world. President Donald Trump issued a brief message of condolence on social media saying: "Rest in Peace Pope Francis. May God Bless him and all who loved him."

Church plans funeral, election: The death of a pope begins a precise sequence of events that includes the confirmation of death in the pontiff's home, the transfer of the coffin to St. Peter's Basilica for public viewing, and a funeral Mass and burial. Interment must take place between the fourth and sixth days after his death.

Latin American pontiff ministered with humble style

By Nicole Winfield
Associated Press

VATICAN CITY — Pope Francis, history's first Latin American pontiff who charmed the world with his humble style and concern for the poor but alienated conservatives with critiques of capitalism and climate change, died Monday. He was 88.

The Vatican said Francis died of a cerebral stroke that put him into a coma and led to irreversible heart failure.

Bells tolled in churches from his native Argentina to the Philippines and across Rome as news spread around the world.

"At 7:35 this morning, the Bishop of Rome, Francis, returned to the home of the Father. His entire life was dedicated to the service of the Lord and of his Church," Cardinal Kevin Farrell said from the chapel of the Domus Santa Marta, where Francis lived.

Turn to Ministered, Page 4

Jury deliberating in trial of state senator

By Madeline Buckley, Jason Meisner and Caroline Kubzansky
Chicago Tribune

For years, state Sen. Emil Jones III pursued anti red-light camera legislation in Springfield, federal prosecutors alleged, always demurring when legitimate lobbyists sought to change his mind.

It was only when a camera executive offered Jones campaign money and a perk — \$5,000 and a \$15-an-hour job for his intern — that Jones finally changed his tune, prosecutors said Monday as they closed their bribery case against him.

"Legislators and legislation should not be up for sale for

any price," Assistant U.S. Attorney Tiffany Ardham told the jury. "That is a crime."

Now the jury hearing the case will determine if that criminal stamp applies to Jones.

His defense attorney, Victor Henderson, made a bid to dodge that label by pitching the case as a David versus Goliath battle between the government and one man, arguing that federal investigators deployed the executive to try to entrap Jones into taking a bribe.

Jones, Henderson said, never took a bribe and instead aimed to get a contribution of food for a legitimate campaign event.

"He doesn't go to Omar. They

Turn to Trial, Page 8

Prairie birds in steep decline, study says

By Nara Schoenberg
Chicago Tribune

The dapper black and yellow bobolink likes the Chicago area so much he flies here every spring from South America — a journey of about 6,000 miles.

By no means depleted, the plucky visitor goes on to dazzle the females of his species with a high-energy courtship display in which he soars over wildflower-studded fields, flapping

his wings rapidly and singing a bright, burbling tune.

In the vast nature preserves surrounding the city, he is joined by the crafty eastern meadowlark, the elusive Henslow's sparrow, the stubby grasshopper sparrow, the tiny sedge wren and the gold-splashed dickcissel.

"If you go to a grassland in the Chicago area — if it's big enough — you're going to see those birds," said Chicago Bird Alliance President Judy Pollock. "The whole

area used to look like that so it's kind of like going back in time."

But if iconic grassland birds still appear to flourish here, the story is very different when the camera pans out across the Midwest and the Great Plains, according to the latest State of the Birds Report by scientists at U.S. bird conservation groups.

The nation's grassland birds, spread across 320 million acres

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Mayor initiates budget group

Mayor Brandon Johnson warns of financial "crossroads" if Trump makes cuts. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Walgreens to pay \$300M settlement

Allegations include filling millions of invalid prescriptions for opioids. **Business**

Trump assails Fed Reserve's Powell

President Donald Trump demands the central bank lower its key interest rate. **Nation & World**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High 71 Low 51

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 16

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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